
INSIGHT · COMMISSIONING & OPERATIONS

DATA CENTER PREVENTIVE MAINTENANCE: BUILD A PROGRAM THAT PRODUCES USEFUL DECISIONS

Preventive maintenance should do more than show that a task occurred. It should establish what was serviced, under which operating conditions, what was observed and which findings require action.

Uptime Institute's 2026 operator survey reports that power was responsible for 56% of respondents' most damaging outages. That survey result is market context, not proof that a specific maintenance program will prevent an outage.

BEGIN WITH AN ACCURATE FACILITY BASIS

Before setting a service schedule, confirm:

- Assets and systems included in the program.
- Current equipment records and available documentation.
- Operating role and criticality.
- Access, isolation and safety requirements.
- Manufacturer information and owner-approved procedures.
- Known conditions and service history.
- Responsibility for parts, findings and follow-on work.

An incomplete asset basis can turn a detailed calendar into a misleading picture of coverage.

DEFINE THE MAINTENANCE BOUNDARY

The scope should state which assets and tasks are included, what is excluded, how often approved work occurs, what conditions must exist and who owns decisions before and after the visit.

Do not use broad phrases such as “complete coverage” unless the agreement defines and supports them.

COORDINATE PLANNED WORK WITH OPERATIONS

The operating team should understand timing, access, system state, required authorizations, communications and restoration expectations. Work that affects active infrastructure needs a clear boundary between maintenance activity and operational control.

MAKE FINDINGS ACTIONABLE

A useful record distinguishes:

1. Work completed.
2. Condition observed.
3. Item requiring monitoring.
4. Item requiring repair or replacement.
5. Issue requiring engineering, retrofit, expansion or power review.
6. Responsible owner and next decision.

This structure helps prevent observations from disappearing into narrative notes.

CONNECT MAINTENANCE TO THE WIDER LIFECYCLE

Some findings are not maintenance tasks. They may reveal a documentation gap, design constraint, power issue, commissioning question or need for capital work. The program should have a route for moving those findings into the correct decision process.

WHERE EVOLVE FITS

Evolve remains engaged after turnover through monitoring, maintenance and long-term support. its documented capability also includes upgrades, expansions, retrofits, power conversions and commissioning. Facility counts and response terms are not represented as universal service commitments.

EXPLORE PREVENTIVE MAINTENANCE

EXPLORE EXPANSIONS & RETROFITS

DIRECT ANSWERS

WHAT MAKES A PREVENTIVE-MAINTENANCE RECORD USEFUL?

It identifies the asset, task, condition, result, finding, responsible party and next action in a consistent format.

CAN PREVENTIVE MAINTENANCE GUARANTEE UPTIME?

No. It supports structured risk management and asset care, but it does not eliminate every failure or external event.

HOW OFTEN SHOULD MAINTENANCE OCCUR?

Intervals depend on approved equipment information, operating conditions, owner requirements, service history and applicable procedures. This guide does not prescribe one universal frequency.

Prepared by Evolve Data Center Solutions. Market sources retrieved September 7, 2026. Market facts are attributed to their sources and are not Evolve performance claims.

SOURCES

- [Uptime Institute, Global Data Center Survey 2026](#) (July 2026)